# Rhoads India Pvt. Ltd.

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This document shall be reviewed periodically or as and when there is a change in organizational policy, statutory requirements or business processes. Any amendments shall be approved by the competent authority and communicated to employees through official channels.

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# Welcome Note – CEO Office

Dear Team,

Welcome to RHOADS! I'm pleased to have you as part of our team. Your role is crucial to our mission, and we value the contributions you will bring to our company.

This HR Employee Handbook is an essential resource designed to provide you with a comprehensive understanding of our policies, procedures, and workplace standards. It outlines the values we hold, the expectations we set, and the support systems we have in place to ensure a positive and respectful work environment for everyone.

I encourage you to take the time to thoroughly read through this handbook. It will equip you with the knowledge needed to navigate our company's practices and maximize the benefits, rights, and responsibilities available to you as an employee. Understanding these guidelines is vital for your success and for maintaining the collaborative and inclusive culture that we are proud of at RHOADS.

We are committed to ensuring that every individual is empowered, respected, and supported. Thank you for being part of this journey with us, and I look forward to the many achievements we will accomplish together.

Warm regards,

**N. Venu Gopal**

**CEO**

# Welcome Note – CISO Office

Welcome to RHOADS! In today's digital age, security is everyone's responsibility, and I'm thrilled to have each of you as a part of our team, helping to protect the integrity of our company. As your Chief Information Security Officer (CISO), I want to personally highlight the importance of safeguarding our assets—both physical and digital—and ensuring compliance with policies that protect us all.

This handbook is more than a rulebook—it's a guide to ensuring that we protect our data, assets, and each other. By following these policies, you're helping us maintain a secure, trustworthy environment where we can all thrive. Whether it's safeguarding sensitive information or adhering to privacy standards, every action you take makes a difference.

Together, we'll ensure that our company remains a fortress of security, where trust and innovation flourish.

Stay secure!

**Nikhil Raj**

**Group CISO**

# Welcome Note – Senior Manager HR

A warm welcome to RHOADS! I'm thrilled to have you with us. As you settle in, I invite you to explore our HR Employee Handbook—it's not just a collection of policies but your guide to navigating our vibrant workplace.

Think of this handbook as your compass, guiding you through our policies, culture, and the values that shape our workplace. It's packed with insights about your rights, benefits, and expectations—everything you need to thrive here!

I encourage you to dive in and explore. By understanding these guidelines, you're not just familiarizing yourself with the company; you're also joining us in our commitment to creating an inclusive and empowering environment.

Welcome aboard! Together, let's make RHOADS a fantastic place to work.

**Suman Chawla**

**Senior Manager - HR**

# Guidelines

This handbook has been prepared to inform new Employees about the policies and procedures of this Company and to establish the Company's expectations.

It is not all inclusive or intended to provide strict interpretations of our policies; rather, it offers an overview of the work environment. This handbook is not a contract, expressed or implied, guaranteeing employment for any length of time and is not intended to induce an Employee to accept employment with the Company.

All Employees are expected to familiarize themselves and comply with this handbook, the Code and all applicable policies and procedures. As an employee, you are responsible for abiding by the Company's policies and regulations. Your awareness and understanding of these guidelines are necessary for your continued growth as well as the growth of our business.

In addition to the policies outlined in this handbook, the Company maintains other policies, procedures, and guidelines that may apply to your role or employment. Employees are encouraged to refer to the Company's intranet (https://adms.aithent.com/) to access and familiarize themselves with these additional resources during the course of their employment.

The Company reserves the right to revise, modify, delete, or add to all processes and practices described in this handbook at any time with or without advance notice and in the Company's sole discretion. Your continued employment after any of these policy changes indicates your agreement with these policies. If there is ever a discrepancy between the information in this handbook and the actual policies or procedures on a certain subject, the policy or process will prevail.

# About RHOADS

Rhoads is a technology-driven compliance solutions provider specializing in the insurance industry. The company offers cloud-based software and managed services that help insurance carriers, agencies, brokers, and adjusters efficiently manage regulatory compliance requirements, including licensing, appointments, renewals, and ongoing monitoring.

Rhoads's flagship platform, **PCRM (Professional Compliance Requirements Management)**, is designed to automate complex compliance processes, reduce risk, improve operational efficiency, and enable organizations to focus on growth while remaining compliant with regulatory obligations.

# Vision

To transform regulatory compliance in the insurance industry through innovative technology, automation, and trusted expertise, enabling organizations to operate efficiently and confidently in a highly regulated environment.

# Mission

To deliver scalable, reliable, and automated compliance solutions that simplify regulatory requirements, reduce operational risk, and support our clients in achieving business excellence and sustainable growth.

# Values

1. **Integrity and Compliance Excellence :** We are committed to accuracy, transparency, and adherence to regulatory standards, ensuring trust and reliability in everything we do.

2. **Innovation and Continuous Improvement :** We embrace technology and innovation to modernize compliance processes and continuously improve our products and services.

3. **Customer-Centric Approach :** We focus on understanding our clients' needs and delivering solutions that enhance efficiency, reduce complexity, and create measurable value.

4. **Collaboration and Accountability :** We believe in teamwork, ownership, and accountability—working together internally and with our clients to achieve shared success.

5. **Reliability and Professionalism :** We strive to be a dependable compliance partner by delivering consistent, high-quality solutions and services.

# Work Practices:

### Working Hours and Office Timings

RHOADS follows a five-day work schedule (Monday to Friday). Office timings vary by location and work requirements.

**Gurgaon Office**

- Day Shift: 8:30 am to 5:30 pm (Monday to Friday)
- Night Shift: 6:30 pm to 2:30 am (Monday to Friday)
  *Note: Night shift timings may vary based on Daylight Savings adjustments.*

**Chennai Office**

Day Shift: 9:00 am to 6:00 pm (Monday to Friday)

**Lunch Break**

Employees are entitled to a lunch break of up to 30 minutes.

# Employee Id number

Upon joining RHOADS, each employee is assigned a unique Employee ID by the HR department This ID must be used for all internal communication, administrative activities and official documents. Employees are advised to keep their ID number for further reference.

# Attendance, I-Card and Personnel File

### Attendance Sign-In / Sign-Out Register

- In addition to the access card, an attendance register containing individual cards with employee names and ID numbers is available at reception. Employees must sign and record their daily arrival and departure times on this register.
- Employees on the **night shift** must also sign in on any of the attendance registers within 15 minutes of their scheduled start time as a grace period.
- Employees arriving after the grace period must sign in the Late Arrival Register, which is available at the office entry gate with Security.

### Employee Identity Card

A temporary access card is issued to all new employees at the time of joining to facilitate entry into the office premises. New joiners must submit a recent photograph and required personal details (name, blood group, and emergency contact information) to the Admin Department for issuance of the permanent ID card. The permanent card will be issued within 7 working days of joining.

Employees are required to always wear their ID cards while on company premises, during interactions with clients/visitors, and for logging in and out, for security and verification purposes.

### Personnel Details

The company maintains a personnel file for each employee starting from the date of employment. This file contains all documents and information relevant to the employees' service with the organization.

New joiners must submit a recent photograph along with personal details such as current address and blood group to the HR Department. Employees are also required to provide photocopies of testimonials supporting their educational qualifications and previous work experience, as per the joining checklist shared with the offer letter.

To ensure accurate and updated records, employees must promptly notify the HR Department of any changes in personal information, including residential address, telephone numbers, emergency contact person, and dependent details.

# Salary Account

Salaries for Employees are processed on the 7th of every month for the preceding month :

- Gurgaon location : Salaries are processed and credited to HDFC Bank salary accounts.
- Chennai location : Salaries are processed and credited to State Bank of India (SBI) salary accounts.

Employees are required to obtain Salary Account Opening Form from the Finance & Accounts Department for their respective banks (HDFC for Gurgaon and SBI for Chennai)

For any assistance or additional information, employees may contact the Finance & Account team.

# Reimbursements

Reimbursement forms are available with the Finance Department to claim eligible expenses.

All reimbursement bills must be submitted to the Finance Department no later than the last working day of the month, to enable timely verification and processing. Approved reimbursements will be paid along with the monthly salary on the 7th of every month.

# Employee Policies

## Code of Conduct Policy

### 1. Purpose

The Employee Code of Conduct ("Code of Conduct") outlines standards of personal and professional conduct that all employees shall strive to always uphold and behave in an ethical and professional manner. The Code provides a basis for all employees to maintain a working environment that is productive, positive, enjoyable, safe, and free from harassment and discrimination. It will also assist managers to induct employees, scope and address any circumstances that may have arisen which conflict with the stated standards and values.

### 2. Scope

The Employee Code of Conduct provides clear guidelines and standards for the appropriate behavior expected of RHOADS Technologies Pvt Ltd. ("RHOADS" or "Company") employees.

All employees are expected to be aware of, and comply with, this Code of Conduct and its related policies.

### 3. Process

a) This Code of Conduct provides a framework for appropriate behavior for all RHOADS employees where they can address ethical issues, with fellow employees and management.
b) Conduct themselves towards other employees or colleagues, employee representatives and their representatives, government authorities and clients, etc. in an appropriate manner.
c) Perform their duties and obligations in a diligent manner, fulfil the mission, goals, and objectives of RHOADS, and Practice fairness and equity.

### 4. Managers / Supervisors Responsibilities:

All Managers are responsible and accountable for:

a) Undertaking their duties and behaving in a manner that is consistent with the provisions of this Code of Conduct.
b) Informing and making the employees in their teams aware of the provisions of this Code of Conduct and other relevant policies, procedures, minutes etc.

c) Providing appropriate training and/or performance counselling to ensure the required standards are met.
d) Reporting any departure from the Code of Conduct by themselves or others.
e) Acting consistently and fairly in dealing with behavior that breaches this Code of Conduct.

## 5. Employee's Responsibilities –

All employees of RHOADS shall have the following responsibilities:

a) All employees shall during their services with the RHOADS devote their whole time and attention to the Company's business as entrusted to them, and they shall not engage themselves directly or indirectly in any business or service other than the Company's business or service.
b) Information pertaining to the Company's operations shall remain secret and safeguarded by the employees. All information that comes to their knowledge by virtue of their employment with the Company is deemed to be confidential.
c) The employees will be required to effectively carry out all duties and responsibilities assigned to them by their respective managers and/or other people authorized by the company to assign such duties and responsibilities.
d) The employees will be required to apply and maintain the highest standards of their personal conduct and integrity and comply with all the Company's policies and procedures. The Company shall have the right, from time to time, to vary or modify any of the above terms and conditions of service, which shall be strictly applicable & must be adhered to by all the employees.
e) All acts of misconduct and indiscipline like insubordination, gross negligence, corruption, fraud, forgery, misappropriation, data sharing, etc. would warrant strong disciplinary action from the Company. Any violations as detailed above or violation of any other procedures and policies of the Company would attract action/termination as per the Company's disciplinary policy in force.

## 6. Attendance and Punctuality:

Employees are expected to be punctual and regular in their attendance. Any non-adherence shall be dealt with according to the Company's Attendance & Discipline Policy.

a) When an employee is unavoidably absent from work due to sickness or any other reason, the employee should telephonically intimate his/her concerned manager (or appropriate delegate) promptly (preferably before their normal starting time) and indicate their likely return to work. In case employee has been away from it for more than 3 days then he/she should ensure written communication via mail & request respective manager to approve his/her leaves.
b) Dress and Appearance: - RHOADS is well-recognized and respected and projects a particular image to its clients. Employees must therefore ensure that their appearance is neat, clean, and appropriate for their particular area of work. A high standard of personal hygiene is always expected.

c) This Code of Conduct intends to define appropriate dress code for the employees employed in RHOADS. Casual business wear is defined as: Trousers, pants, skirts, Modest shirts, Shirts, jumpers, cardigans, non-sports jackets, Denim jeans or leggings any form of sports shoes including joggers or runners) does not include thongs, slippers or dilapidated footwear athletic wear torn or ripped clothing (even if 'designer' tears). Unsuitably revealing clothing (including backless tops or dresses, or garments that reveal the midriff) any clothing displaying offensive messages including racist.

d) Personal behavior and conduct: Employees are required to undertake their duties in a professional, responsible, conscientious, and ethical manner and to act in the best interests of the RHOADS. They are expected to act honestly in all their duties when dealing with clients, customers, contractors, and fellow employees. Natural justice, fairness, and equity. If an employee is required to investigate complaints against other employees or issues affecting employees, they must act consistently, promptly, and fairly and in a timely manner. The principles of natural justice must be maintained in dealing with each investigation.

e) Use of facilities and equipment: Employees should take all possible care when using RHOADS's property, goods, intellectual property and services and ensure that the same are used efficiently, carefully and honestly. Unless permission has been granted by the employee's manager, RHOADS resources are not to be used for private purposes.

f) Privacy and use of personal and official information: Employees have an obligation to ensure that professional information is secured against loss, misuse or unauthorized access, modification, or disclosure. Employees have a duty to maintain the confidentiality, integrity, and security of official information for which they are responsible.

g) Records management: - Employees need to be aware of their record-keeping responsibilities and are reminded that there is a legal requirement under applicable laws to adhere to proper records management practices and procedures. All employees must therefore ensure that RHOADS documents are not placed in unofficial or private filing systems and must place such documents in official files. Employees must not damage, dispose of, or in any other manner interfere with official documents or files. The destruction of records may only take place in accordance with a disposal and retention schedule, duly approved by the CEO of the Company.

h) Information technology: -Employees must not access information which they are not authorized to access or use and must not allow any other person to access the same for any reason. Employees must take all reasonable precautions, including password maintenance and file protection measures to prevent unauthorized access and have an obligation to maintain the security and confidentiality of the information systems over which they have responsibility or control and that are owned or used by agreement.

i) Financial interests: Employees should avoid any financial involvement or undertaking that could directly or indirectly compromise or undermine the performance of their duties or the RHOADS's objectives or activities. Financial conflict of interest may arise where an employee has a financial interest in a company or other business or is able to influence contracts or transactions between the RHOADS and that business. This conflict may extend to any business undertaking in which employees have their immediate family or when the employees are acting in direct competition with RHOADS's activities or interests for personal gain.

j) Acceptance of commissions, gifts, or benefits: Employees should not accept a gift, secret commission or a benefit from a person or organization outside the RHOADS if the intent of the gift or the benefit is to induce the employee to waive or reduce requirements or to

extend a financial or other benefit to a person or organization outside the RHOADS to the detriment of the RHOADS interests. As a rule, no employee should accept a gift or benefit if it could be seen as intended or likely to cause that person to perform their job in a particular way, which the person would not normally do, or deviate from the proper or usual course of duty. Employees may accept token gifts or benefits in circumstances approved by the Chief Executive Office of the Company, or a nominee appointed by the Company, if there is no possibility that the employee might be perceived to be compromised in the process. Gifts of nominal value generally used for promotional purposes by the donor, or moderate acts of hospitality may be accepted by employees.

## 7. Employee / Client boundaries

a) The term 'employee/client boundaries identify the importance of the trust inherent in the relationship between the employees and their clients, however, breaching of employee/client boundaries mean going outside the limits of the employee/client relationship.
b) Employees are expected to maintain proper boundaries with their clients. Employees are expected to make themselves aware of any workplace and/or program-specific policies/guidelines in this area.
c) Relatives and close friends
d) A conflict of interest may arise where an employee makes or participates in decisions affecting another person with whom they have a personal relationship (such as a relative, spouse, close friend, or personal associate).
e) In cases where such a conflict of interest may arise, employees must report to their manager. Also, wherever possible, employees should disqualify themselves from dealing with those people in such situations.
f) Alcohol consumption and substance abuse or misuse
g) Employees must ensure that the safety and health of other employees, volunteers and clients are not endangered by any misuse. RHOADS expects employees to perform their jobs with skill, care, and diligence. Employees should not perform any act or omission that is likely to have a detrimental effect on their work performance and that of other employees and clients. Accordingly, employees should not be under the influence of alcohol or other substances while they are at work or at work functions.
h) Possession, use or trafficking in illegal drugs in RHOADS's premises is not permitted. RHOADS's premises include but are not limited to all buildings, vehicles, car parks, meeting rooms, and open spaces. Any such activity will be immediately referred to the police and RHOADS may take disciplinary action, which may include termination of employment.
i) Employees must notify the manager if the taking of, or failure to take, prescribed medication is likely to affect their performance and/or affect the safety of any person at the workplace. This is to ensure workplace safety is not jeopardized and that any performance impact is properly managed. It is the responsibility of employees to follow the directions/precautions for any drugs prescribed by a health professional for individual use and/or commercially available preparations that may impact their capacity.

## 8. Smoking

a) Passive smoking can have impact on other employees, the community and create a poor image of RHOADS, which does not promote or encourage smoking. Smoking is not permitted in RHOADS owned or leased vehicles or buildings.
b) Employees may only smoke in their own time during authorized breaks as set out in the award, agreement, or employment contract and/or as authorized individually by their manager.

## 9. Policies & Procedures

Employees are responsible for carrying out and complying with RHOADS policies and procedure and legislation. It is acknowledged that employee views, on specific matters, may differ from RHOADS; however, such views must not either interfere with the performance of an employee's duty or prevent the employee from supporting RHOADS's objectives.

## 10. Compliance with lawful instructions

Employees must comply with any lawful instruction given by any person who has authority to make or give such an instruction.

## 11. Bullying

Bullying is unreasonable behavior that is directed against an individual or group by another individual or group and is derived from the misuse of power over the target of the behavior. This may include verbal abuse, shouting excluding or isolating behavior deliberately withholding information vital for effective work performance giving employees impossible assignments physical abuse. Bullying is an unacceptable conduct within RHOADS premises, and all reported incidents will be investigated. Whilst it is the responsibility of all employees within RHOADS to ensure that premises and facilities are free from harassment, managers also have a particular and clear responsibility to meet this requirement. Managers who become aware of serious instances of bullying must immediately notify their manager or the CEO.

## 12. Harassment

Harassment is any type of behavior that the other person does not want and does not return offends, embarrasses, or scares them, and may be either sexual or non-sexual in nature targets them because of their race, sex, pregnancy, or other protected attribute under the law constitutes a form of bullying.

Harassment does not have to be a series of incidents or an ongoing pattern of behavior. Neither does harassment need to be intentional to attract disciplinary action. Harassment can occur in any work-related context including:

a) Social functions
b) Conferences
c) Office social gatherings
d) Business trips

Harassment and discrimination form part of a continuum of unacceptable behavior that can include sexual assault, stalking and harassing phone calls, some of which are also against criminal law, which means the police may prosecute anyone who commits such acts. All cases of sexual harassment shall be considered under the RHOADS's disciplinary policy in force and any breach of the same shall invoke penalty as mentioned in the Company's disciplinary policy.

a) Occupational safety and health: RHOADS is committed to providing a safe and healthy workplace for all employees and visitors; however, employees have a responsibility to make the workplace a safe and healthy place for all concerned, as far as is reasonably practical.
b) It is therefore important that employees are familiar with the standards or procedures in their specific area of work. If employees have not been advised of these standards or procedures during the induction process, they must ask their immediate manager to obtain the necessary information.
c) External employment: The employees shall not engage themselves in any employment other than their employment with RHOADS in any manner beyond the business hours of RHOADS. The employees shall provide full time devotion and commitment to their obligations under their employment with RHOADS and shall not engage themselves in any other employment, placing them in conflict with their official duties and likely to affect their efficiency in the performance of their duties. Further, the employees shall not accept any outside payment for an activity which does not form a part of their normal work activities under the employment of RHOADS.
d) Ownership of products and copyright: All products, literary, dramatic, musical, cinematographic and artistic works, computer programs, material in written or other format, discoveries, inventions and improvements in relation to such matters, together with all copyright and intellectual property created, authored, discovered, developed or produced by the employee for the purpose of, or in the course of, the employee's employment will remain the property of RHOADS and will not be used by the employee other than for the purpose of RHOADS's business.

e) Upon termination of employment the employee will return all correspondence, documents, data, information, equipment, and things, including copies thereof, belonging to the employer that may be in the employee's possession, custody, or control.

f) Public conduct and media contact: Employees making comments in a public forum on any matter relating to RHOADS must act in a way that is in keeping with the values and protects the reputation of RHOADS. Only authorized personnel may speak with the media on behalf of RHOADS. Employees are not permitted to speak with media representatives without first receiving clearance from the CEO.

g) Misuse: Employees must not deliberately misuse RHOADS's equipment, assets, or the services of other RHOADS personnel. When using RHOADS's equipment, employees are required to follow the instructions provided to avoid personal injury and/or maintenance and replacement costs. Examples of misuse include:
   - Copying computer software programs regardless of whether or not the programs are protected by copyright.
   - Use of the RHOADS letterhead paper or postage when corresponding on personal or other matters not directly related to RHOADS.
   - Unauthorized use of the RHOADS logos.
   - Falsifying, manipulating, or destroying business records without specific authorization.
   - Using RHOADS equipment for personal commercial gain.
   - Employees provided with vehicles (private or commuter use) are expected to use them in accordance with the RHOADS policy and guidelines.

h) Confidentiality: Employees may have access to personal or commercial information relating to individuals, the public, or the financial or other operations of RHOADS. This information is to be used for RHOADS purposes only and should remain secure and confidential. It is important that the community has confidence that information acquired by RHOADS's only used for the stated purposes for which it was collected. Employees must not discuss or release any unauthorized person and/or anyone outside of RHOADS, any confidential or sensitive information relating to RHOADS and/or its operations.

i) Breaches of the Code: RHOADS's committed to the standards set out in this Code of Conduct. Where a breach of the Code has been identified by RHOADS a response to the breach may result in:
   - Counselling
   - disciplinary action
   - termination of employment
   - suspension; or
   - Laying of criminal charges or civil action

j) Email: Staff may only use e-mail and web browsing for work-related purposes, and all e-mail and web access logs will be monitored for compliance with the staff position. As the organization has responsibility for its computer systems and networks, it has the right to make directions as to its use. Informing people about the personal information that is collected held and what is done with it is an important principle.

# Background Verification Policy

**1.0 Background:**

Protect company and its employees and its customers from potential risks.

**2.0 Objective:**

The objective of the policy related to the back-ground check is to make sure that RHOADS complies with data protection and Security requirement of our clients and partners. In addition, this ensures that we extend the offer of employment who meet the desired standard of ethical and personal conduct that RHOADS upholds.

**3.0 Scope**

Effective 3rd March 2021 onwards all offered candidates will go through background checks before joining.

The background check includes –

i. Minimum employee qualification shall be a graduate degree. Any higher qualification shall be subject to the discretion of the appointing authority and shall be verified accordingly.
ii. One criminal verification through court record check (Law Firm) on Permanent address
iii. Two Residential address verification (Present & Permanent)
v. Two last employment credentials

vi. One global database search

**4.0 Process of background check**

i. The BGVC process begins only after a candidate accepts the job offers or joins the company. The employer can start the verification by uploading the candidate's details on the BGVC portal, or the candidate can directly upload the required documents when requested.

*The complete background check gets done within 14 working days on the date of joining. (TAT of 14 Business days excludes any delays due to unavoidable circumstances like strikes, holidays, delay in certain Colleges / Universities, or other Force Majeure events*.

ii. The personal record of individuals that are shared with the third-party partner gets deleted periodically from their system to maintain privacy related to personal information. The RHOADS Human Resources team ensures this.

**5.0 List of Criminal Charges:**

RHOADS is committed to providing a safe working environment for its Employees. Hence, the following convictions will result in the withdrawal of an offer of employment.

i. Homicide
ii. Manslaughter
iii. Criminal vehicular murder and injury
iv. Assault

v. Kidnapping
vi. Criminal sexual conduct
vii. Conviction for Dowry and Domestic Violence
viii. Robbery
ix. Theft and/or burglary
x. Terroristic threats
xi. Arson
xii. Harassment and/or stalking statue
xiii. Dismissal from the last employment for aggravated sexual harassment.
xiv. Financial fraud

**6.0 Parameters of Possible Discrepancies**

Understanding and addressing these parameters is crucial for enhancing security and user experience in authentication systems. Therefore, following are the parameters of possible discrepancies:

i. Change in name without official documental evidence.
ii. Any University / Institution which is listed as Fake under University Grants Commission will be Discrepant.
iii. Fake Certificates / Documents
iv. Period of Employment beyond 2 months variation
v. Exit not clear / not completed.

vi. Overlap in Period between two employments.

vii. Incorrect Personal Information

viii. Negative Criminal Report

**7.0 Disclosure of material facts**

An offered candidate will be automatically disqualified from further consideration if they fail to accurately provide the complete information in the Background Check Authorization Form.

**8.0 Exception for Rejoining Employees**

Educational qualification verification may be waived for rejoining employees who have previously completed the Company's background verification and whose education records are available. All other checks will be conducted as per Company policy and discretion.

# Leave Policy

## Background

Leave policy outlines the rules and regulations related to various types of leaves that an Employee can avail. This policy lays down provision for the Employees to balance their personal as well as professional life.

All permanent Employees of RHOADS are entitled to paid time offs under this policy.

## Objective:

The Objective of leave policy is to:

i. Support employee well-being and work-life balance.
ii. Ensure compliance with labour laws and regulations.
iii. Maintain fair and consistent leave practices.
iv. Facilitate effective attendance management.
v. Aid in resource planning and workforce management.
vi. Enhance communication and transparency.
vii. Foster employee retention and satisfaction.
viii. Provide legal protection for the organization.

## Scope:

i. There are different types of leave categories to cater to unique time off needs of Employees.
ii. Sufficient days of notification are to be given to the reporting Manager before the leaves are availed depending on the category and number of leaves taken.
iii. Employees need to ensure that they have kept their colleagues and reporting Manager informed of their ongoing tasks and that they are reassigned accordingly during absent time.
iv. Out of office notification is turned on to let people know that Employee is not available and whom to contact in their absence to maintain minimum disruption to work.
v. Apply and get the leaves approved by the reporting Manager before the payroll cut-off date.
vi. Any emergency leave shall be updated within 2 working days of resuming the work.
vii. Leaves are employee privilege and should be treated as such. The organization trusts Employees that they are providing true reasons while they avail leaves.
viii. Employees going on long duration leave is requested to provide contact number so to connect with them during any emergency.

## URL Link

Leave and Attendance System: Leaves are to be applied and submit the leave application; it has to be done prior to proceeding on leave as below:
https://aipc.aithent.com/AIPC/

## Types of Leaves:

Every Employee excluding those with permanent WFH, are entitled to leaves under the following leave categories.

| Leave Category | Abbreviation | Number of leave days | Accrual |
|---|---|---|---|
| Privilege leave | PL | 18 days | Refer to the policy |
| Casual Leave | CL | 07 days | Refer to the policy |
| Sick Leave | SL | **07 days** | Refer to the policy |
| Maternity Leave | ML | 26 weeks | As per provisions under Maternity Benefits Act |
| Paternity Leave | PL | 05 days | Limited to two deliveries |
| Bereavement Leave | BL | 02 days | Calendar Year |
| Compensatory off | CO | Authorized | Refer to the policy |
| Time Off | TO | Authorized & 2.5 hrs.x3/month | Refer to the leave policy |
| Leave without Pay | LWP | Authorized | Refer to the leave policy |
| Employee on notice period | - | - | Refer to the leave policy |
| Employees on permanent WFH | PWFH | Authorized | Refer to the leave policy |

## Privilege leave - PL:

i. Maximum 18 days of Privilege leave for continuous service of twelve months which shall be credited every 4 months of service (i.e.) 6 leaves per 4 months.

ii. This is to be treated as earned leave and cannot be given in advance.

iii. The Leave account of the employees will be credited with 6 days of leave or part thereof, monthly depending on completion of actual/active days during the past 4 months.

iv. For availing PL, a new employee has to put in four months of service.

v. No advancement of PL shall be applicable.

vi. All holidays/ weekly offs / festival leaves falling during the leave period shall be counted in the leave period.

vii. **During release of an employee from service, whether due to resignation/ termination, balance leave will be encashed, up to a maximum of 40 days. PL cannot be availed during the notice period.**

viii. **The amount payable for encashment of PL at the time of resignation/separation shall be calculated as the no. of days to be encashed (Up to a maximum of 40 days) / 30 * Last salary drawn (Salary for the purpose shall include Basic pay as applicable from time to time.)**

### Revised PL carry-forward limits, One-time utilization window and Forfeiture rules post w.e.f 1st January 2026

- Privilege Leave can be accumulated up to a maximum of 45 days.
- Employees who have a PL balance exceeding 45 days as of 31st December 2025 may utilize the excess leave (above 45 days) during the period 1st January 2026 to 31st December 2026.
- After 31st December 2026, any PL balance above 45 days will not be carried forward and will be forfeited.

## Casual Leave (CL):

i. Casual Leave is granted for certain unforeseen situations or when employee wishes to avail up to 3 days leaves to attend to a personal matter or emergency.

ii. Employees are entitled to get 07 Casual Leaves in a calendar year.

- At the beginning of each year, the employee's casual leave account will be credited with seven days as advance credit.
- Employees joining during the middle of the calendar year will be credited leave on a pro-rata basis as per their date of joining.

iii. Casual Leave shall be taken for a minimum of 0.5 to a maximum of 3 days. No extension beyond three days is allowed and for longer duration the Employee should opt for PLs instead of CL.

iv. Casual leave cannot be available during notice period. Un-availed casual leaves at the end of the calendar year shall lapse.

v. This category of leave cannot be appended with PL or SL.

All holidays/ weekly offs / festival leaves falling during the leave period shall be counted in the leave period.

- The employee who resigns during the calendar year and has availed casual leave more than entitlement, will have his excess leave adjusted against Privilege Leave, or salary as applicable.

- All trainees / interns / temporary employees shall have the facility to avail one day of Casual Leave (CL) for every month of service. Leaves can be accumulated and availed as and when required.

## Sick Leave (SL):

i. Sick Leave is granted to an Employee if the Employee is unable to attend to their duties because of sickness.

ii. **Employee is entitled to get 7 sick Leaves (Revised w.e.f 1st January 2026) in a calendar year which shall be credited at the beginning of the calendar year.**

iii. The leave credit to the sick leave account will be credited in advance by 1st January of each calendar year. Employees joining in the middle of the calendar year will have a leave credit on a pro-rata basis.

iv. Sick Leave can be taken for a minimum of 0.5 to a maximum of 3 days. For days over and above 3 days, leave should be supported with required medical documentation and approved both by the Manager and HR Head.

v. Sick leaves un-availed during the calendar year, shall be carried forward to the next calendar year. Leave credit on this account shall not exceed 12 days. Any leave of more than 12 days shall be liable to lapse automatically. At the time of separation all leave credit on this account shall automatically be lapsed.

vi. SL can be available on a pro-rata basis as per the last working day during the notice period.

**All holidays/ weekly offs / festival leaves falling during the leave period shall be counted in the leave period.**

## Maternity Leave (ML):

i. Maternity Leave is covered by Maternity Benefits Act, 1961 (including amendment - 2017) in which Female Employees are entitled to a maximum of 26 weeks of paid maternity leave. Of these 26 weeks, not more than 8 weeks shall precede the expected date of delivery. For a female Employee with 2 or more children, the Maternity leave eligibility is 12 weeks.

ii. A woman worker is entitled to maternity benefit only if she has worked at least 80 days in an establishment in the 12 months prior to her expected date of delivery.

iii. In case of miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy, an Employee is entitled to six weeks of paid maternity leave. However, must submit a medical certificate in original from Registered Medical Practitioner indicating the reason for leave (miscarriage/abortion).

iv. The Employee availing ML must submit a medical certificate in original from Registered Medical Practitioner indicating the reason for leave (delivery) – indicating expected date of delivery.

v. ML would not be treated as break-of-service and all benefits due in the normal course would be payable.

vii. The Employee needs to provide information at least three (03) months in advance before the expected date of delivery.

viii. ML cannot be accumulated or encashed.

## Paternity Leave

I. Paid leave for 5 days from date of delivery. This would be available at a maximum of twice during the service at RHOADS.

II. All holidays/ weekly offs / festival leaves falling during the leave period shall be counted in the leave period.
III. Paternity Leave shall be taken in a block of continuous five (05) days.

## Leave Without Pay (LWP):

Consumption of leave beyond accumulated or granted leave, attracts the situation of leave without pay (LWP) duly authorized by HR/ Reporting Manager.

## Bereavement Leave:

i. To extend solidarity with a personal loss all permanent Employees are granted with 2 days of Bereavement leaves in a year for the demise of the immediate family members.
ii. The Bereavement leaves can be combined with annual leaves.
iii. Immediate family members mean – Parents, Parents in Law, Spouse, Children and Sibling only.
iv. These leaves do not get accrued or carry forward and lapse at the end of the year.

## Compensatory Off:

i. Compensatory off should be availed within -3 months from the actual date of its origin and these compensatory offs cannot be availed beyond two days in one instance (in case of multiple Comp Off availability). If not availed during the defined timeline, they will not be extended.
ii. Compensatory off can be applied only after prior approval from the Reporting Manager.
iii. The guiding principle is to avoid working on off days/holidays. However, in case of business exigencies, if Employees are required to work on their off / holidays, Company shall provide a mechanism to compensate Employees for their efforts. This should be more of an exception than practice and applicable to all Employees. Employees will be eligible for one compensatory off against each day when they are asked to work .
iv. Comp off can be combined with all weekly offs/ public holidays/ festival leave falling during the leave period.
v. **Any unutilized compensatory off balance as on 31st December of the calendar year shall automatically lapse and shall not be carried forward to the next year.**

## Permanent work from home – PWFH:

The annual leave entitlement for WFH employees will be as follows:

- **PL** : 9 (Maximum accumulation will be last year's carry forward plus up to 40 days)
- **CL**: 4
- **SL**: 3 ( Maximum accumulation will be last year's carry forward plus up to 6 days)
- **Time Off:** Nil

**Revised PL carry-forward limits for PWFH employees), One-time utilization window & Forfeiture rules w.e.f 1st January 2026:**

- Revised PL Carry Forward: - Maximum carry forward limit: 21 days
- Employees who have a PL balance exceeding 21 days as of 31st December 2025 may utilize the excess leave (above 40 days) during the period 1st January 2026 to 31st December 2026.
- After 31st December 2026, any PL balance above 21 days will not be carried forward and will be forfeited.

## Time Off:

Project Leaders and Functional Heads may in their judicious discretion allow employees a reasonable time off/ permission to come late/ go early maximum 03 instances in a month. This facility/ authority should ideally be used to keep in view the prolonged extra effort put in by the employee concerned to meet the exigencies of work.

Time Off limits entitlement of an employee to late login or early log off by 2.5 hrs. on a working day with authorization.

Leave Entitlement in case of Trainees/ Interns/ Temporary Employees.

**Revised applicability of Time Off Facility w.e.f 1st Jan 2026 : Time Off facility is not applicable to employees availing Hybrid Work Policy and Permanent Work from Home employees.**

## Unauthorized Absence:

When an Employee is absent without proper approval of the Reporting Manager, the corresponding absence of the Employee shall be treated as unauthorized leave even though the Employee may have leave available in their credit. An absence without approval for more than 3 days would be a case of abscondment and will call for disciplinary process which may lead to termination of service.

## Employee on Notice Period:

i. PL and CL cannot be availed during the notice period.
ii. SL shall be availed in a month on a pro-rata basis as per the date of resignation while an Employee is on their notice period.
iii. An Employee cannot be on leave on their last working day in the organization. If the Employee avails more than the allotted leaves, then the notice period will be extended by those many days.
iv. Notice Period payout cannot be adjusted against PL surrendered.

## Combination of leaves:

Casual Leave (CL) cannot be combined with Privilege Leave (PL) or Sick Leave (SL). However, Privilege Leave (PL) can be combined with Sick Leave (SL) and Special Leave. For combining Sick Leave (SL) with Privilege Leave (PL) medical certificate from a Registered Medical Practitioner must be submitted.

## NOTE

All employees are required to ensure that they submit online leave application and get it approved by their reporting manager well in time as the salaries shall be prepared based on those leave application(s) and attendance records available at the time of computation of salaries. No request for correction of salaries shall be entertained later. Any employee who is deputed on an assignment abroad should also fill the online leave application for any leave taken. All consultants deployed overseas will inform HR about any leave taken during their stay overseas through email.

# Performance Review Policy

## Objective

The purpose of the Annual Performance Evaluation process is to promote effective communication and provide constructive feedback on job performance, identify strengths and areas for improvement, set goals for future performance, and facilitate better working relationships.

## Scope

This policy applies to all employees of RHOADS, except contractual staff.

## Procedure

The performance appraisal is conducted annually in the month of October and is based on individual performance as defined in the employee's job profile.

Employees are encouraged to seek guidance and support from their managers and peers to improve assigned tasks. The HR Manager and Reporting Manager shall identify training needs, if any, during counselling sessions or the annual assessment.

**Effective Date of Appraisal**

The effective date of appraisal shall be considered as follows:

- Employees joining on or before the 15th of a month: the effective date will be the 1st of that month.

- Employees joining after the 15th of a month: the effective date will be the 1st of the following month.
- For trainees, the appraisal date shall be based on their date of confirmation.

**Appraisal Process**

**Step 1:** HR/OPM generates the list of employees due for annual appraisal for the current cycle and initiates the process.

**Step 2:** Appraisal forms are emailed by HR/OPM to employees, with a copy to the Reporting Manager, indicating the submission deadline. HR shall ensure that all forms are received within the stipulated timeline.

**Step 3:** All appraisals shall initially be completed by the immediate Reporting Manager and/or Project Lead / Department Head. Inputs may also be sought from clients, the CEO, and other stakeholders, as applicable.

**Step 4:** The Reporting Manager submits the completed appraisal forms with ratings and feedback to HR/OPM in soft copy by the date specified in the appraisal communication.

**Step 5:** HR or the Review Committee (if any) shall discuss the ratings provided by supervisors and finalize the ratings. Increment amounts shall be determined based on the Reporting Manager's recommendations, internal benchmarking, available budget, and final ratings.

**Performance Rating Scale:**

| Performance Level | Score |
|---|---|
| Excellent | 80% and above |
| Very Good | 70% to 79% |
| Good | 55% to 69% |
| Satisfactory | 40% to 54% |
| Unsatisfactory | Below 40% |

**Step 6:** Career planning and future work planning shall be key components of the review process. Role Level (RL) changes shall be discussed and finalized. Records of previous RL changes shall be maintained for reference, and the RL structure shall be reviewed to ensure compliance with defined periodicity. Job rotation opportunities may also be discussed and finalized.

**Step 7:** For declaration of increments, the OPM Manager shall schedule a meeting with the Appraiser and Appraisee to discuss feedback. Upon completion of the meeting, the OPM Manager shall communicate the increment to the employees and share the details with the Finance team.

**Step 8:** Increments and promotions shall be decided based on current compensation, internal benchmarking, and the following factors:

- Performance in the current role.
- Potential for future responsibilities.
- Additional skills or knowledge acquired.
- Contribution to revenue generation, including timely deliveries, process improvements, cost savings, or other significant achievements.
- Work plan for the next review period, jointly agreed upon by the employee and supervisor.
- Personal attributes such as work habits, attitude, teamwork, leadership qualities, and overall contribution to organizational success.
- Feedback from stakeholders including superiors, subordinates, peers, and customers.

**RHOADS management reserves the right to modify/extend/suspend this scheme/policy at any time.**

# Employee Referral Policy

**Background:**

The Employee Referral & Internal Job Transfer Policy outlines the guidelines for employees, recommending potential candidates and for employees seeking internal job transfers. The policy encourages leaders and employees to refer qualified individuals for open positions and provides a structured process for evaluating and rewarding successful referrals. It also defines the steps and criteria for employees interested in transferring to different roles or departments within the company.

The policy aims to leverage the internal talent pool, enhance employee engagement, and create a culture of professional growth and development, while ensuring fairness, transparency, and consistency in both hiring and internal movement processes.

**Objective:**

The objective of this policy is to establish a structured framework for employee referrals and internal job transfers within the organization. It aims to utilize the network and insights of existing employees to attract high-quality talent, streamline recruitment, and support career mobility within the company. This promotes employee development, engagement, and retention, aligning with RHOADS' s long-term strategic staffing goals.

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**Employee Referral Process**

1. The referral process begins when the Recruitment/HR team posts a job opening on the company website, job boards, noticeboards, or via email/meetings with the HR team.
2. The job description is shared along with the job posting to help employees understand the required skills and competencies.
3. Employees may refer suitable candidates by submitting their details to the HR/Recruitment team.
4. Referrals must be submitted by emailing the candidate's resume to the designated recruitment email ID.
5. The Recruitment team reviews the referred candidate's resume to assess suitability based on the job description.
6. While referring to a candidate, employees must mention:

- Employee Code
- Name
- Job Title
- Department
- Date of Joining
- Total Tenure with RHOADS

7. Former employees may be referred only if they left RHOADS at least one year prior to the referral.
8. The HR team will inform the referring employee if the referral has been accepted or rejected to avoid duplicate submissions.
9. The referred candidate will undergo the standard interview and selection process.
10. When the candidate is selected, the HR team will notify the referring employee.
11. The referral bonus, once due, will be added to the employee's salary as per the payout rules.
12. If multiple employees refer to the same candidate, the bonus will be awarded to the employee who submitted the referral first.

**Referral Bonus Payment Rules**

1) The referral bonus will be paid only after the referred employee completes three months of continuous employment with RHOADS.
2) At the time of bonus disbursement, both the referring employee and the referred employee must be active employees of RHOADS.
3) If an ex-employee rejoins within one year of separation, the hire will not qualify for referral bonus.
4) 50% of the bonus will be paid after the referred employee completes three months with RHOADS.
5) The remaining 50% will be paid after the referred employee completes six months of continuous service.

6) In cases where multiple employees submit the same candidate's resume, the incentive will be awarded to the employee who submitted it first, based on timestamp records.

7)

**Referral Bonus Structure**

| RL Level | Referral Bonus (INR) |
|---|---|
| RL 3 to RL 5 | ₹25,000 |
| RL 6 to RL 8 | ₹35,000 |
| RL 9 and above | ₹50,000 |

**ALL DECISIONS MADE BY THE MANAGEMENT ARE FINAL.**

# Dress Code Policy

**Objective**

All personnel should be dressed formally during the first four working days of the week. The dress need not be expensive but should be well made and well maintained and in the same manner, proper attention needs to be given to personal grooming.

**SCOPE**

All employees of RHOADS.

**MALE PERSONNEL**

- Suits/Combination/Bush-shirts/Shirts tucked into trousers are acceptable dresses for male personnel. Flowery & printed bright colored shirts should be avoided. Semi- Casual clothing like T-shirts/ Colorful shirts, may be worn on Fridays & weekends.
- Sandals/chappals should not be worn to work. Socks should always be worn with Shoes. Shoes should be well polished/clean.
- Personnel not sporting a beard should shave every morning. Those with beard/ Mustache should keep them well trimmed.

**FEMALE PERSONNEL**

- Sarees/ Salwar Kameez/ any other non-casual/ non-high fashion dress is acceptable. Transparent and skintight dresses should be avoided. Semi - Casual clothing like T-shirts/ Colorful shirts, may be worn on Fridays & weekends.
- Footwear should be formal.
- Heavy jewelry should be avoided.

# POSH Policy

## 1.0 Purpose

RHOADS Technologies Pvt. Ltd. (“the Organization”) is committed to providing equal opportunity and a harassment-free workplace, irrespective of race, caste, religion, colour, ancestry, marital status, gender, sexual orientation, age, nationality, ethnic origin, or disability. The Organization believes that all employees have the right to be treated with dignity and respect.

The Organization considers sexual harassment at the workplace, or arising out of employment, as a serious offence and strictly prohibits such behaviour.

At RHOADS, all employees are expected to uphold the highest standards of ethical conduct at the workplace and in all professional interactions. Employees are expected to:

- Treat everyone with dignity and respect.
- Comply with the letter and spirit of the law.
- Refrain from any unwelcome behaviour of a sexual nature.
- Avoid creating a hostile work environment through sexual misconduct.
- Report any incident of sexual harassment experienced or witnessed and cooperate with the complaint-handling procedure.

This Policy is framed in accordance with the provisions of the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 and the corresponding Rules, 2013.

## 2.0 Scope

- This Policy applies to all employees (male and female), including trainees, interns, consultants, contractual and temporary staff, at all levels of the Organization.
- The Policy covers allegations of sexual harassment by one employee against another.
- It also applies to allegations involving third parties such as vendors, contractors, service providers, customers, or visitors, whether the incident occurs on or off Company premises, if it arises out of employment.

## 3.0 Important Definitions

**Employee**

Any person on the rolls of the Company, including those on deputation, contract, temporary, part-time, internship, training, or working as consultants.

**Workplace**

All establishments of the Company in India, including any location where employees perform official duties or visit in connection with work. This includes transportation provided by the Company.

**Sexual Harassment**

Sexual harassment includes, but is not limited to:

- Unwelcome physical contact or advances
- Demand or request for sexual favours
- Sexually coloured remarks
- Showing pornography

- Any other unwelcome verbal, non-verbal, or physical conduct of a sexual nature

**The following circumstances may also amount to sexual harassment:**

- Promise of preferential treatment in employment
- Threat of detrimental treatment
- Threat regarding employment status
- Interference with work or creation of a hostile environment
- Humiliating conduct affecting health or safety

**Aggrieved Individual**

Any person, of any age, whether an employee or not, who alleges to have been subjected to sexual harassment.

**Complainant**

An aggrieved individual or a person filing a complaint on behalf of the aggrieved individual as permitted under the Act.

**Respondent**

The person against whom the complaint is filed.

## 4.0 Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)

The Organization has constituted an **Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)** in accordance with the Act.

**The ICC shall consist of:**

- A Presiding Officer (senior woman employee)

- At least two employee members
- One external member from an NGO or relevant body
- At least **50% of the members shall be women**.
- Members shall hold office for a term not exceeding three (3) years.
- A quorum of **three members**, including the Presiding Officer, is mandatory.

## 5.0 If You Are Being Harassed

Employees are advised to:

- Clearly communicate that the behaviour is unwelcome.
- Maintain a record of incidents.
- Report on the matter to the ICC.
- File a complaint at the earliest.

## 6.0 Redressal Process

- Complaints must be submitted in writing within three (3) months of the incident.
- The ICC shall share the complaint with the respondent within 7 working days.
- The respondent must reply within 10 working days.
- Conciliation may be attempted at the request of the complainant.
- During inquiry, ICC may recommend interim relief including transfer or leave.

- False or malicious complaints may attract disciplinary action.

## 7.0 Enquiry Process

- Inquiry must be completed within 90 days.
- Legal representation is not permitted.
- Both parties shall be given full opportunity to present their case.
- The final report shall be submitted to management within 10 days of completion.
- Management shall act within 60 days.

## 8.0 Appeal

Any person aggrieved by the ICC recommendations may file an appeal before the appropriate authority within 90 days.

## 9.0 Miscellaneous

- Strict confidentiality shall be maintained.
- Annual report shall be submitted to the CEO.
- Police complaints shall be initiated for IPC offences.

## 10.0 Penal Consequences

Sexual harassment is a cognizable offence under Section 354A of IPC, punishable with imprisonment up to three years, fine, or both.

## 11.0 Duties of Employer

- Provide safe workplace
- Display ICC details
- Conduct awareness programs
- Assist in filing IPC complaints
- Support ICC operations

## 12.0 Duties of ICC

- Promote gender sensitization
- Conduct fair inquiries
- Maintain records
- Recommend disciplinary actions

# 13.0 Amendments

This Policy may be reviewed and amended in line with changes in applicable laws.

# Corporate Team Lunch Policy

**Objective**

The purpose of this document is to promulgate / Officially announce company policy relating to the reimbursement of corporate team lunch/dinner expenses as an initiative towards employee welfare.

Corporate team lunch/dinner paves the way to improve communication in the workplace and build a bond among team members. It also provides opportunities for new recruits and introverts to interact with the team.

**Applicability**

This policy is applicable to all full-time, part-time, Trainee and contract staff. The policy is effective from 1st January 2023.

**Guidelines to be followed:**

- Once in a year team lunch / dinner to be planned by the team manager for his / her team(s)
- In case one Project team manager is managing two teams in that case manager is free to combine both the teams together for team lunch / dinner.
- In case a person is working on multiple projects, Project Managers coordinate with each other and take both teams together to avoid exceeding the available budget for a year. One such example is QA members work on multiple projects.
- The manager needs to keep HR informed as to when the team will be going for lunch or dinner, and he must specify the time for the lunch / dinner and return to work. Total budget for the year is to be distributed across months, so it's important that the managers inform HR ahead of time.
- Team lunch/dinner budget should include food costs and transportation costs only (transportation, if required).
- Bills of food and transportation charges should be submitted in accounts for reimbursement.
- Reimbursement will be paid based on actual expenses as per approved budget.
- All claims for reimbursement of expenses are to be supported by the actual and relevant bills only.
- Annual budget allocated for Team Lunch / Dinner is Rs.3,00,000/ (This is for 300 employees)- Per employee the cost would be Rs.1000/- including GST.

Note: This policy is subject to modification from time to time as may be decided by the Management.

# Visitor Policy

## Background

The Visitor Policy is a set of guidelines established by an organization to regulate the access and behavior of visitors within its premises. This policy outlines the procedures for visitor registration, security checks, and the responsibilities of both visitors and employees regarding safety, confidentiality, and compliance with organizational rules and regulations. The primary goal of a Visitor Policy is to maintain security, protect sensitive information, and ensure a safe and welcoming environment for all individuals while aligning with the organization's overall security and operational objectives.

## Objective

The objective of the Visitor Policy is to establish clear and standardized protocols for managing visitors within an organization's premises. This policy aims to enhance security, safeguard sensitive information, and promote safety for both visitors and employees by defining visitor registration procedures, access restrictions, and behavioral expectations. Ultimately, it seeks to create a secure and well-managed environment that aligns with the organization's security and operational goals while ensuring a positive and controlled visitor experience.

## Visitor Guidelines

## Workplace Visitor

1) Visitors are welcome during regular working hours. If you plan to visit after hours, please obtain written authorization from HR, Administration, or management.
2) Before entering the workplace, visitors must obtain permission from the relevant manager or Administration.
3) Upon arrival, visitors should sign in at the reception, gate, or front office, providing their entry time and showing government-issued identification for verification.
4) Visitors will be issued an entry pass or badge (without a photo) at the security desk, reception, or front office upon entering the office.
5) While inside the office premises, visitors are required to always wear the issued badge and return it when leaving.
6) For safety and guidance, all visitors must be accompanied either by security personnel or office support staff during their stay within the office premises.
7) When departing the office, visitors should also sign out at the reception, gate, or front office, indicating their exit time.

### Personal Visitor

Visitors coming to meet employees are kindly requested to be received in designated areas such as the visitor room, lobby, or reception area, and their visit should be brief and purpose specific. Access to other office areas is only allowed with prior authorization from the Manager of Administration. Employees are accountable for their visitors' behavior and safety. If an unauthorized person is spotted on RHOADS's premises, employees should promptly inform the Manager of Administration of the necessary action.

### Contractors, Service Vendors and Candidates

Contractors, suppliers, service vendors, and interview candidates are permitted access to our premises solely for their respective job-related purposes. Our Security and Admin teams are responsible for issuing badges to contractors and vendors and ensuring that they wear these badges consistently while on our premises.

The same protocol applies to interview candidates, who should be accompanied by either support staff or security personnel until they reach the designated HR representative. The HR representative is then responsible for the candidate's well-being and supervision while they are within the office premises.

### Unauthorized Visitors

Our security personnel have the authority to request unauthorized visitors to vacate the premises. Visitors who engage in disruptive behavior or unlawful activities, such as hate speech or theft, will be promptly asked to leave, and legal action may be taken when warranted. Employees who encounter unauthorized visitors are encouraged to report them to either the security team or the office manager for appropriate action.

Important Note – Disciplinary Action

Employees who violate this policy may face disciplinary consequences in proportion to their violation. HR will determine how serious an employee’s offense is and take the appropriate action.

# Disciplinary Guidelines and Disciplinary Appeal Policy

## 1.OBJECTIVES

This policy outlines the Company's approach to managing employee conduct and performance issues in a fair, consistent, and transparent manner. It provides employees with guidance on expected behavior and explains the process the Company follows when disciplinary action becomes necessary. It also outlines the employees' right to appeal against disciplinary decisions.

## 2.SCOPE

This policy applies to all employees of the Company, irrespective of role, grade, or tenure.

## 3.Principles of Disciplinary Action

The Company follows these guidelines:

- **Fairness:** All cases are examined impartially based on facts and evidence.
- **Consistency:** Similar issues are handled in a uniform manner across the organization.
- **Confidentiality:** Information is shared strictly on a need-to-know basis.
- **Opportunity to Respond:** Employees will be given a chance to explain their position before any action is taken.
- **Progressive Discipline:** Wherever appropriate, the Company will follow a step-by-step approach to correcting behavior.

## 4.Types of Misconduct

Misconduct may include, but is not limited to:

- Violation of Company policies or Code of Conduct
- Absenteeism or repeated late coming
- Insubordination or refusal to follow reasonable instructions
- Misuse of Company property or confidential information
- Harassment, bullying, or inappropriate behavior

- Fraud, theft, or dishonesty
- Any act that affects productivity, workplace harmony, or the Company's reputation

## 5.Disciplinary Process

**5.1 Informal Counselling :** For minor issues, managers may resolve concerns through verbal counselling and guidance.

**5.2 Formal Disciplinary Steps : Depending on the severity and frequency of misconduct, the Company may take the following actions:**

- Verbal Warning – Issued for initial or minor issues.
- Written Warning – Issued when behavior does not improve or for more serious misconduct.
- Final Written Warning – Issued when serious or repeated misconduct continues.
- Suspension or Withholding of Benefits – Temporary action pending investigation or as part of disciplinary action.
- Termination of Employment – For severe violations or repeated disregard of Company policies.

**Note: The Company reserves the right to bypass stages depending on the seriousness of the misconduct.**

## 6.Investigation Procedure

When a complaint or misconduct is reported:

- A fair and unbiased investigation will be conducted.
- Employees involved may be asked to provide written statements.
- Relevant evidence will be reviewed before concluding.

Employees are expected to cooperate fully during an investigation.

## 7.Disciplinary Appeal Process

### 7.1 Right to Appeal

An employee has the right to appeal a disciplinary decision if they believe:

- The decision was unjust
- The procedure was not followed correctly

- New evidence is available
- The action is disproportionate to misconduct

### 7.2 Appeal Procedure

- The employee must submit a written appeal to HR within **5 working days** of receiving the disciplinary decision.
- The appeal must clearly state the grounds for appeal.
- An independent reviewer or senior management member will reassess the case.
- The final decision will be communicated in writing to the employee.

### 7.3 Final Decision

The decision of the reviewing authority will be **final and binding**.

## 8.Record Keeping

- All disciplinary actions, warnings, and appeal outcomes will be documented and retained in the employee's personnel file as per Company policy.

## 9. Management Discretion

Based on the severity of the issue or organizational needs, the Company may take immediate action without following progressive steps. All decisions made by management will be final.

# Employee Separation Policy

**OBJECTIVE**

To provide guidelines that are to be followed by staff at the time of separation from the organization due to any of the below listed reasons:

i. End of Contract
ii. Resignation
iii. Retrenchment / Redundancy
iv. Retirement
v. Termination of Services
vi. Unforeseen Event

**APPLICABILITY**

This policy is applicable to all full-time, part-time and contract staff. The policy is effective from 1st January 2023.

**END OF CONTRACT**

- A contract if not renewed will end on the date mentioned in the contract.
- Reporting manager of the staff shall provide review feedback and recommendations for renewing the contract or ending the contract to HR.
- The HR will then forward this recommendation to the CEO for renewal / termination of the

**RESIGNATION**

- It is a permanent separation from employment that is initiated by the employee.
- Any staff planning to leave the organization should submit the resignation email to their respective team managers marking a copy to the HR.
- The respective team managers should have a discussion with the staff within 5 days from the date of receipt of the resignation email to understand the reason.
- Post this discussion, with mutual consent if, the staff decides to stay back he /she shall submit the withdrawal of resignation email within 3 days of meeting with the team manager.

- Else if the staff decides to continue with the decision to resign, acknowledgement of the resignation email will be issued to the staff by his/her Project Manager and the same will be forwarded to the HR for further action.

**NOTICE PERIOD**

- Notice period of 90 days will begin from the date when the staff concerned has submitted the resignation.
- Staff are required to serve the full notice period or pay in lieu the salary for notice period not served as per policy.
- Under such circumstances, the amount payable for unserved notice period will be adjusted against the gross salary payable.
- However, Organization at its discretion can relieve staff from the services earlier than the above defined notice period in case he / she has fulfilled all work commitments and respective project manager will give his go ahead to HR for early relieving

**LAST WORKING DAY**

- The last working date will be decided by the team manager and updated to the staff and HR.
- If the last working day falls on a holiday or weekend, the staff will be relieved on the working day prior to the holiday / weekend.
- Relieving-cum-Service letter will be issued to staff after all exit formalities are completed and within a week after his / her exit.

**LEAVES DURING NOTICE PERIOD**

- Staff are not allowed to take any leave during the notice period.
- In exceptional cases (medical or other exigency) staff may be allowed to avail SL on a pro-rate basis up to the last working date.

**RETRENCHMENT / REDUNDANCY**

- The organization will notify the staff that their employment will be terminated on grounds of redundancy.
- The organization may retrench staff for reasons not relating to their performance or behavior. This may happen in case of re-structuring of functions for strategic reasons, which is at the discretion of the management.
- In such cases, the organization will provide notice or payment in lieu of notice to the staff concerned.

**UNFORSEEN EVENT**

In the event of death of staff while in service, Organization shall render the following assistance:

- The organization will provide the necessary support to the staff in terms of any financial help that they may need to deal with the emergency.
- Advance amount, if required to take care of immediate expenses may be provided.
- Full and final settlement of dues will be done within 15 days from which the advance will be adjusted.

- Will expediate Provident Fund / Insurance claim settlements and other statutory benefits grant to the deceased staff as accrued during his / her employment with the organization.

**HANDOVER & CLEARANCE OF DUES**

- The exiting staff must complete his / her work and commitments before the relieving date.
- The staff must settle all amounts due to the organization prior to his / her separation.
- The staff should handover any returnable property of the organization to the IT Manager / Admin or Team manager
  - Laptop, Data Card, Barcode reader, Laptop bag, etc.,
  - Mobile Locker keys, ID and Access Cards, Stationery, Library Books, etc.,
- Staff must complete the exit clearance form and submit it to HR to proceed with Exit interview.

**EXIT INTERVIEW**

- The outgoing staff must fill in the exit interview form and submit it to HR
- The inputs would be used by HR to understand staff experience in the organization and reasons for his / her resignation and develop action plans for improvement.

**FULL & FINAL SETTLEMENT**

- Last month's salary of the resigned staff will be released as full and final settlement within 30 days after his / her exit.
- The salary & benefits will be calculated on pro rata basis up to the last working date.
- The net amount dues will be paid to the staff after adjusting the deductions and recoveries as applicable.

Note: This policy is subject to modification from time to time as may be decided by the Management.

# Mobile Usage Policy

**Objective**

To minimize disruptions, maintain productivity, and ensure that mobile phone usage does not affect work efficiency.

**Scope**

Applies to all employees of RHOADS.

**Guidelines**

- Limit personal calls: Prolonged or frequent personal calls during working hours are discouraged as they impact productivity.
- Keep ringer silent/vibration: Employees should keep phones on silent or vibration mode to avoid disturbance.
- Use phones only for essential calls: Non-essential conversations should be avoided during work hours.
- Allow calls to go to voicemail: If unsure of the importance of an incoming call, allow voicemail to receive it.
- No mobile usage during meetings: Phones should not be used for calls, texts, browsing, social media, or gaming during meetings.

# Joining Process and Procedures

## Objective

To ensure a smooth, consistent, and controlled process for onboarding new employees and to maintain accurate records and documentation related to each new hire.

## Procedure

**Joining & Onboarding Process**

**1. Pre-Joining Communication**

Prior to the date of joining, HR will share a welcome communication with the new employee, which may include:

- Office address and location details
- Reporting time and first-day instructions
- Contact details of the concerned HR representative

The Company may also initiate internal arrangements for system and infrastructure readiness before the joining date.

**2. Joining Day Formalities**

On the first day of employment:

- The employee is required to report as per the Offer Letter.
- HR will facilitate the onboarding formalities, including system access initiation and completion of mandatory joining documentation.
- The employee will be provided with necessary resources to ensure a smooth start.

- The Company may provide complimentary meals on the first working day, as per applicable shift timings and internal practices.

**3. Employee Records & Personnel File**

HR maintains a personnel file for every employee. This may include (as applicable):

- Offer and Appointment Letters
- Educational and professional certificates
- Identity and address proofs
- Previous employment documents
- Statutory and payroll-related records

Employees are responsible for ensuring that their personal information remains accurate and updated. Any change in address, contact details, nominee, qualifications, or other personal data must be promptly communicated to HR.

**4. Forms, Declarations & Agreements**

Employees are required to complete and sign mandatory forms and agreements, which may include:

- Code of Conduct
- Employment Agreement / NDA
- Information Security and Data Protection declarations
- Insurance and personal information forms
- Other statutory or organizational documents as applicable

**5. Employee ID & Access**

- Each employee will be assigned a unique Employee ID.
- An access card or temporary access may be issued for office entry and system usage, subject to Company policies.

**6. HR Policy Orientation**

HR will provide an overview of key organizational policies and procedures, including but not limited to:

- Code of Conduct
- POSH Policy
- IT & Information Security Policy
- Leave and attendance guidelines

Employees are expected to familiarize themselves with all policies shared.

**7. Team Introduction & Workplace Familiarization**

HR will introduce employees to their respective team and facilitate basic workplace orientation to help them integrate into the organization.

**8. New Joiner Communication**

The Company may announce new employees internally through official communication channels.

**9. Appointment Letter**

- The Appointment Letter will be issued after completion of document verification and background checks (where applicable).
- The employee is required to acknowledge and return a signed copy to HR.

**10. HR Induction Program**

Employees may undergo a structured HR induction covering:

- Organizational overview
- Internal systems and portals
- Compliance and governance requirements

**11. System & Portal Access**

Employees will be provided with access to relevant internal systems such as:

- Leave and attendance systems
- Timesheets
- Intranet or internal tools

Access is subject to role, authorization, and Company security policies.

**12. Records & Documentation**

All employment-related records, forms, acknowledgments, and agreements are maintained by HR in the employee's personnel file, in line with data privacy and record retention policies.

# Recruitment Process

## Objective

To define a clear, consistent, and transparent recruitment procedure for hiring employees.

## Scope

Applicable to all recruitment activities at RHOADS.

## Procedure

**Step 1:** Technical department submits Resource Request Form (RRF) to HR. If internal resources cannot be allocated, HR begins external hiring after CEO approval.
**Step 2:** HR reviews RRF; clarifications are sought if required.
**Step 3:** Screening and shortlisting of relevant profiles.
**Step 4:** Preliminary HR round to assess suitability and overall fit.
**Step 5:** Technical Round 1 (telephonic/face-to-face).
**Step 6:** Technical/Project Manager Round 2 (face-to-face).
**Step 7:** Final round with HR (salary negotiation and fitment).
**Step 8:** Offer letter issuance (post CEO approval if applicable).
**Step 9:** HR maintains regular follow-ups with selected candidates.
**Step 10:** On joining, if a candidate backs out, the next shortlisted candidate is considered.

## Recruitment for Non-Technical Roles

- After HR screening, candidates are interviewed by the requesting department.
- Final round with HR Head.

## Sources of Recruitment

1. Employee referrals
2. Direct applicants (networking, job portals, search engines)
3. Recruitment agencies and consultants

**Note:** This policy is reviewed annually.

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# Whistleblower Policy

## Purpose

To provide a safe mechanism for reporting suspected illegal, unethical, or inappropriate practices without fear of retaliation. The policy promotes integrity, transparency, and accountability.

## Scope

Applies to all employees, contractors, vendors, and stakeholders.

## Definitions

- **Whistleblower:** Employee who reports concerns under this policy.
- **Protected Disclosure:** Good-faith report of unethical/illegal behavior.
- **Subject:** Person against whom a disclosure is made.
- **Investigators:** Individuals authorized to conduct investigations.

## Roles and Responsibilities

**Employee/Whistleblower**

- Report unethical or unlawful practices.
- Submit written complaints through the designated email.
- Refrain from independent investigations.

**Audit Committee**

- Receive complaints and decide on investigation requirements.
- Select investigating agency/committee.
- Monitor investigation progress and corrective actions.
- Maintain confidentiality.
- Recommend disciplinary actions.

**Investigating Agency/Committee**

- Conduct fair, objective, and confidential investigations.
- Submit findings to the Audit Committee/CISO.

**General Guidelines**

- All disclosures must be made in good faith.
- HR handles employee-related protected disclosures.
- This policy does not cover personal grievances already addressed through other HR policies.
- Reportable issues include:
    - Violation of laws or regulations
    - Fraud, misappropriation, or theft
    - Falsification of company records
    - Misconduct or gross negligence
    - Anti-competitive behavior
    - Criminal activities
    - Any act harmful to company stakeholders

**Disqualification**

- False, malicious, or frivolous disclosures may lead to disciplinary action.
- Whistleblowers found guilty of misuse of the policy may be disqualified.
- Complicit individuals are not protected from disciplinary measures.

**Reporting Process**

- Reports must be addressed to the **Group CISO** at: **whistleblower@RHOADS.com**
- Anonymous disclosures are not accepted.
- Reports must be factual and supported with evidence/details.

**Protection Against Retaliation**

- Whistleblowers are protected from discrimination, harassment, or adverse employment actions.
- Any retaliation should be reported to HR.
- Confidentiality of the whistleblower will be maintained to the fullest extent possible.

**Investigation and Reporting**

- Investigations are assigned based on issue complexity.
- Investigators must follow a fair and unbiased process.
- If wrongdoing is confirmed, corrective or disciplinary action will be recommended.
- The Audit Committee submits annual reports summarizing disclosures and outcomes.

# TRAINING POLICY

## OBJECTIVE

RHOADS believes that employee development is essential for achieving organizational goals. The objective of this policy is to enhance employee knowledge and skills, ensure compliance with statutory requirements, and support overall professional growth.

## SCOPE

This policy applies to all employees of RHOADS.

## TYPES OF TRAINING

### Internal Training

RHOADS primarily provides the following internal training:

- Induction / HR orientation
- Cyber Security and Information Security
- POSH (Prevention of Sexual Harassment)
- HIPAA / Compliance training
- Functional and soft skills training

**Technical training** will be provided only on a need basis, depending on business requirements.

### External Training

External training may be sponsored for specialized skills, subject to management approval.

## TRAINING FEEDBACK

Feedback will be collected to assess:

- Program quality
- Relevance
- Trainer effectiveness
- Impact on performance

**POLICY REVIEW**

This policy will be reviewed annually.

# Roles & Responsibilities Policy

*(All Designations & Role Levels – RL)*

**1. Purpose**

This policy defines the roles, responsibilities, reporting structure, authority, and accountability for all designations as per the official Role Level (RL) framework of the organization.

**2. Scope**

This policy applies to all employees across all functions, departments, and locations.

**3. Governance & Compliance**

All employees shall comply with the following policies and regulations:

- Information Security
- POSH (Prevention of Sexual Harassment)
- Data Privacy
- IT Act & Cyber Laws
- Risk Management
- Internal Audit & Compliance Policies

**4. Role Level Framework (Indicative)**

| Role Level | Experience Band |
|---|---|
| RL1 | 0–1 year |
| RL2 | 1–2 years |
| RL3 | 2–4 years |
| RL4 | 4–6 years |
| RL5 | 6–8 years |
| RL6 | 8–10 years |
| RL7 | 10–12 years |
| RL8 | 12–14 years |
| RL9 | 14–16 years |
| RL10 | 16–18 years |
| RL11 | 18+ years |

*(Designations may vary by function but align to the same RL structure.)*

**Role Levels**

| | Years of Experience | 0-1 year | 1-2 year | 2-4 years | 4-6 years |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | **Title** | **Aithent** | **Aithent** | **Aithent** | **Aithent** |
| **ROLE** | Development | Trainee Software Engineer ( RL1) | Junior Software Engineer ( RL2) | Software Engineer ( RL3) | Sr. Software Engineer ( RL 4) |
| | Testing/QA | QA ( RL1) | Junior QA Engineer ( RL2) | QA Engineer ( RL3) | Sr.QA Engineer ( RL 4) |
| | Technical Support | Trainee Technical Support Engineer | Jr.Technical Support Engineer | Technical Support Engineer | Senior Technical Support Engineer |
| | System / Network | Trainee -System Administrator | Jr System Administrator | System Administrator | Senior System Administrator |
| | Database | Trainee Database Analyst | Jr.Database -Analyst | Database Analyst | Database Administrator |
| | Business Analysis | Trainee -BA | Jr. Business Analyst | Business Analyst | Sr. Business Analyst |
| | Business Analysis | Trainee -BA | Jr. Business Analyst | Business Analyst | Sr. Business Analyst |
| | Human Resource | Trainee -HR | Jr. Executive - HR / Recruitment | Executive - HR / Recruitment | Sr. Executive - HR / Recruitment |
| | Accounts | Trainee -Accounts | Jr. Executive - Accounts | Executive - Accounts | Sr. Executive - Accounts |
| | Administration | Trainee -Admin | Jr. Executive - Admin. | Executive - Admin | Sr. Executive - Admin. |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | **Years of Experience** | **6-8 years** | **8-10 years** | **10 -12 years** | **12 -14 years** |
| | **Title** | **Aithent** | **Aithent** | **Aithent** | **Aithent** |
| **ROLE** | Development | Technology Analyst / Sr. Systems Analyst/ Module Lead ( RL5) | Technical Architect/ Team Leader (RL 6) | Technical Architect/ Project Leader ( RL7) | Sr. Technical Architect/ Sr. Project Leader ( RL7) |
| | QA | QA Lead ( RL5) | Sr. QA Leader (RL 6) | Associate Manager - QA ( RL7) | Manager - QA ( RL8) |
| | Technical Support | Technical Support Lead | Senior Technical Support Lead | Associate Manager - Technical Support | Associate Manager - Technical Support |
| | System / Network | IT Administrator | Senior IT Administrator | Associate Manager - IT | Associate Manager - IT |
| | Database | Sr. Database Administrator | Lead Database Administrator | Sr Lead Database Administrator | Sr Lead Database Administrator |
| | Business Analysis | Lead -Business Analyst | Lead -BA | Associate Manager -BA | Assistant Manager -BA |
| | Business Analysis | Lead Business Analyst | Sr. Lead Business Analyst | Associate Manager - Business Analysis | Manager - Business Analysis |
| | Human Resource | AM- HR / Recruitment | AM- HR / Recruitment | Deputy Manager - Recruitment / HR | Manager - Recruitment / HR |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Accounts | AM-Finance & Accounts | AM- Finance & Accounts | Deputy Manager - Finance & Accounts | Manager - Finance & Accounts |
| | Administration | AM- Admin. | AM- Admin. | Deputy Manager - Admin | Manager - Admin |
| | **Years of Experience** | **14 - 16 years** | **16 - 18 years** | **18 - 22 years** | **22 - 26 years** |
| | **Title** | **Aithent** | **Aithent** | **Aithent** | **Aithent** |
| **ROLE** | Development | Project Manager ( RL8) | Sr. Project Manager (RL9) | Group Leader (RL10) | Engineering Leader/ AVP (RL11) |
| | QA | Manager- QA/ Sr. QA Manager ( RL9) | Manager- QA/ Sr. QA Manager ( RL9) | Group Leader - QA (RL10) | AVP - QA (RL11) |
| | Tech Support | Manager - Technical Support | Manager - Technical Support | Senior Manager - Technical Support | |
| | System / Network | Manager IT | Manager IT | Senior Manager - IT | AVP -IT |
| | Database | Manager - Database Administration | Manager - Database Administration | Senior Manager - Database Administration | |
| | Business Analysis | Deputy Manager- BA | Sr. Manager | Sr. Manager | |
| | Business Analysis | Sr. Manager - Business Analysis | Sr. Manager - Business Analysis | | |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Human Resource | Manager - Recruitment / HR | Sr. Manager - Recruitment / HR | Sr. Manager - Recruitment / HR | AVP -HR |
| | Accounts | Manager - Finance & Accounts | Sr. Manager -Finance & Accounts | Sr. Manager - Finance & Accounts | AVP- Finance & Accounts |
| | Administration | Manager - Admin | Sr. Manager - Admin | Sr. Manager - Admin | AVP -Admin. |

## Development Track

- **Trainee Software Engineer:** Learns basic programming skills and supports development tasks under supervision.
- **Junior Software Engineer:** Works on simple modules, bug fixes, and documentation with guidance from seniors.
- **Software Engineer:** Develops, tests, and maintains application features as per project requirements.
- **Senior Software Engineer:** Designs complex modules, mentors juniors, and ensures code quality.
- **Senior System Engineer / Technology Analyst:** Analyzes system requirements, provides technical solutions, and supports project execution.
- **Technical Architect / Project Leader:** Designs system architecture, leads technical teams, and ensures solution alignment with business needs.
- **Senior Technical Architect / Senior Project Lead:** Drives large-scale technical design, mentors architects, and handles critical technical decisions.
- **Project Manager:** Plans and manage projects, ensuring timely delivery, quality, and stakeholder communication.
- **Senior Project Manager:** Oversees multiple projects, manages risks, and drives strategic project outcomes.
- **Group Leader**: Leads multiple teams or projects and aligns delivery with organizational goals.
- **AVP and Above:** Defines technology strategy, drives innovation, and aligns IT with business growth.

## Testing / QA Track

- **QA Trainee:** Learns testing fundamentals and supports test execution under supervision.
- **Junior QA Engineer:** Executes basic test cases and reports defects.
- **QA Engineer:** Designs and executes test cases, performs functional testing, and logs defects.
- **Senior QA Engineer:** Leads complex testing, mentors juniors, and ensures test quality.
- **QA Lead:** Manages large QA teams, defines test strategy, and ensures delivery quality.
- **Associate Manager QA :** Oversees QA operations, manages team performance, and improves testing processes.
- **QA Manager:** Leads QA function, ensures quality standards, and aligns QA with business goals.
- **Senior Manager – QA:** Drives QA strategy, risk management, and quality governance.
- **Group QA Head / Group QA:** Leads multiple QA teams or portfolios and ensures enterprise-level quality.
- **AVP / VP – QA:** Defines overall QA vision, drives quality transformation, and advises leadership.

## Technical Support / IT Support Track

- **IT Support Trainee / Helpdesk Trainee:** Learns basic IT support and resolves simple user issues.
- **Junior IT Support Engineer:** Handles basic system, and application support tickets.
- **IT Support Engineer:** Provides end-user support, troubleshooting, and system maintenance.
- **Senior IT Support Engineer:** Resolves complex issues and mentors junior support staff.
- **IT Support Lead / Team Lead:** Manages support team and ensures SLA compliance.
- **Manager – IT Support:** Oversees IT support operations and infrastructure services.
- **Senior Manager – IT Support:** Drives IT service strategy and business continuity.
- **AVP / VP – IT Support:** Defines IT support vision and enterprise IT operations.

## Database / Data

- **Database Trainee:** Supports data entry and basic database tasks.
- **Junior DBA:** Assists in backups, monitoring, and reporting.
- **Database Administrator (DBA):** Manages database performance, security, and availability.

- **Senior DBA:** Handles large databases and disaster recovery.
- **Database Architect:** Designs enterprise data architecture.
- **Manager – Data / DBA:** Oversees data platforms and governance.
- **AVP / VP – Data:** Defines data strategy and analytics roadmap.

## Business Analyst

- **BA Trainee:** Learns business processes and supports documentation.
- **Junior Business Analyst:** Gathers requirements and prepares basic reports.
- **Business Analyst:** Analyzes business needs and creates functional specifications.
- **Senior Business Analyst:** Leads stakeholder discussions and solution design.
- **Lead Business Analyst:** Manages BA team and ensures delivery quality.
- **Manager – Business Analysis:** Drives business transformation initiatives.
- **AVP / VP – Business Analysis:** Aligns business strategy with technology solutions.

## IT Infrastructure / Networking & Information Security

- **IT Infrastructure Trainee:** Learns basic infrastructure, networking, and security operations.
- **Junior Infrastructure / Security Engineer:** Supports network monitoring, system support, and basic security checks.
- **Infrastructure / Security Engineer:** Manages networks, servers, firewalls, and implements security controls.
- **Senior Infrastructure / Security Engineer:** Leads complex infrastructure and cyber security tasks.
- **Infrastructure / Security Lead:** Oversees network performance and security operations.
- **Infrastructure / Security Manager:** Manages IT infrastructure, cyber security programs, and compliance.
- **Senior Manager – Infrastructure & Security:** Defines enterprise infrastructure and information security governance.
- **AVP / VP – Infrastructure & Security:** Sets overall IT infrastructure and cyber security strategy.

## HR Track

- **HR Trainee:** Learns HR processes and supports the team in basic tasks like data entry, sourcing resumes, and documentation.
- **Junior Executive – HR & Recruitment:** Assists in recruitment, interview coordination, onboarding, and maintaining HR records.
- **HR & Recruitment Executive:** Manages end-to-end recruitment for assigned roles and handles routine HR operations.

- **Senior Executive – HR & Recruitment:** Leads recruitment for key positions, handles employee queries, and supports HR initiatives and compliance activities.
- **Assistant Manager (AM) – HR & Recruitment:** Supervises recruiters, manages hiring plans, and supports performance management and employee relations.
- **Deputy Manager (DM) – HR & Hiring:** Drives recruitment strategy, manages team performance, and ensures timely fulfillment of manpower requirements.
- **HR Manager:** Oversees HR operations, policies, compliance, performance management, and employee engagement.
- **Senior Manager – HR:** Leads major HR functions, drives talent strategy, and partners with business leaders.
- **AVP & VP – HR:** Defines people strategy at an organizational level and aligns HR with business growth, sets HR vision, leads transformation, and acts as strategic advisor to the leadership team.

## Finance Track

- **Accounts: B**asic accounting processes and supports the team in data entry, vouchers, and documentation.
- **Junior Executive – Accounts:** Assists in bookkeeping, invoice processing, and maintaining financial records.
- **Executive – Accounts:** Handles day-to-day accounting, billing, reconciliations, and statutory documentation.
- **Senior Executive – Accounts:** Manages complex accounting tasks, prepares reports, and supports audits and compliance.
- **Assistant Manager (AM) – Accounts:** Supervises accounting activities, ensures timely closures, and supports statutory filings.
- **Deputy Manager (DM) – Accounts:** Oversees financial operations, manages team output, and ensures regulatory compliance.
- **Manager – Finance & Accounts:** Leads finance operations, budgeting, audits, and financial controls.
- **Senior Manager – Finance:** Drives financial strategy, risk management, and business financial planning.
- **AVP & VP – Finance:** Sets financial vision, oversees corporate finance, and advises leadership on financial decisions.

## Admin Track

- **Admin Trainee –** Admin: Learns administrative processes and supports with documentation, coordination, and office assistance.
- **Junior Executive –** Admin: Assists in office operations, vendor coordination, and facility-related tasks.
- **Executive** – Admin: Manages daily office administration, travel arrangements, asset tracking, and vendor follow-ups.
- **Senior Executive –** Admin: Oversees facility operations, security, housekeeping, and ensures smooth office functioning.
- **Assistant Manager (AM)** – Admin: Supervises admin staff, manages vendors, and controls office budgets and logistics.

- **Deputy Manager (DM) –** Admin: Leads administrative operations, negotiates contracts, and ensures compliance with safety and facilities standards.
- **Manager –** Admin: Heads overall administration, infrastructure planning, and vendor management.
- **Senior Manager –** Admin: Drives strategic admin initiatives and supports business continuity.
- **AVP & Above –** Admin: Defines administrative strategy and ensures efficient organizational operations.

This policy shall be reviewed annually or earlier based on organizational or regulatory changes.

# Company Culture & Engagement Highlights

RHOADS is committed to fostering a professional, inclusive, and respectful workplace that supports employee engagement, collaboration, and continuous improvement. The organization promotes a work environment guided by shared values, open communication, mutual respect, and ethical conduct.

Employee engagement initiatives are designed to encourage participation, strengthen teamwork, and support overall workplace well-being, in alignment with business requirements and organizational practices.

As part of its employee engagement and continuous improvement efforts, RHOADS conducts the **Great Place to Work (GPTW) Survey** at periodic intervals. The survey provides employees with an opportunity to share feedback on workplace practices. Participation in the survey is voluntary, and feedback is reviewed to identify opportunities for improvement.

The organization may undertake the following engagement practices:

- **Team and Festive Engagement Activities:** Company-wide events and festival celebrations such as Diwali, Holi, Christmas, New Year, and other regional or cultural occasions may be organized to promote inclusivity and team bonding.
- **Employee Communication:** Organizational updates, including new client additions, business milestones, and client appreciation, are shared through internal communication channels such as the **Calypso e-Newsletter**.
- **Wellness and Work-Life Balance Initiatives:** Wellness programs, awareness sessions, and activities aimed at supporting physical, mental, and emotional well-being may be facilitated.
- **Team Building and Engagement Activities:** Team building and engagement initiatives may be conducted to encourage collaboration and positive workplace interactions.
- **Career Growth and Development:** RHOADS supports employee development by providing hands-on work experience, open discussions, and managerial guidance. Employees are encouraged to engage with their direct managers regarding performance, skill development, and career growth within an open and approachable work environment.

# Glossary of Terms

This section provides definitions of commonly used terms and abbreviations in RHOADS to help employees navigate processes and communication more effectively.

| Term / Abbreviation | Meaning |
|---|---|
| HR | Human Resources |
| IT | Information Technology |
| PF | Provident Fund |
| ESIC | Employee State Insurance Corporation |
| POSH | Prevention of Sexual Harassment |
| HDFC | Bank used rfor salary accounts |
| ID / I-Card | Employee Identity Card |

*Note: Employees are encouraged to refer to this glossary whenever they encounter terms or abbreviations they are unfamiliar with.*